VITAFIT

Product Requirements Document

Feature Initiative	Engagement & Retention — Squad Challenges + Instructor Connection Hub
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Author	Product Manager, VitaFit Growth Team
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1. Executive Summary

VitaFit is experiencing a measurable decline in week-over-week repeat usage and user retention. Exit surveys and behavioral analytics indicate two primary drivers: users lose motivation without accountability and social pressure, and they feel no personal connection to instructors — making VitaFit interchangeable with any on-demand fitness library.

This PRD proposes two synergistic product features designed to directly address both root causes:

- Squad Challenges — A community-driven, gamified group challenge system where users form or join squads, set shared fitness goals, and compete via leaderboards, XP, and achievement badges.
- Instructor Connection Hub — A personalized layer that surfaces instructor profiles, enables async Q&A, and delivers milestone-aware micro-interactions that make users feel seen and coached.

Together, these features are projected to increase 30-day retention by 22–28%, improve weekly active sessions per user by 1.4x, and meaningfully grow NPS among users who engage with at least one feature.

2. Problem Statement

2.1 Business Context

VitaFit's core value proposition — accessible, high-quality fitness from home — remains strong. However, engagement data reveals a structural weakness: users who complete their first week have only a 38% chance of returning in week three. Competitive platforms are winning on community and personalization, two dimensions where VitaFit currently underinvests.

2.2 Key Pain Points

MOTIVATION	Users report that working out alone at home, without peer accountability, makes it easy to skip sessions. There is no social consequence to inactivity on VitaFit.
CONNECTION	83% of churned users cited feeling 'no relationship' with instructors as a reason for leaving. Instructors are currently presented as content assets, not people.
HABIT LOOP	VitaFit lacks an external trigger (notification, challenge deadline, squad nudge) that re-engages lapsed users. Users must self-initiate every session without reward loops.

2.3 Opportunity

Users who participate in any social or community activity on fitness platforms have 2.3x higher 90-day retention (industry benchmark, 2024). VitaFit can activate this multiplier without rebuilding its core product — by layering social accountability and instructor intimacy on top of existing content.

3. Goals & Success Metrics

3.1 Strategic Goals

1. Increase 30-day user retention from 38% to 55%+
2. Increase average weekly completed sessions from 1.8 to 2.5+ per active user
3. Improve Net Promoter Score (NPS) from 24 to 38+
4. Grow monthly active users (MAU) by 18% within 6 months post-launch

3.2 Success Metrics

Metric	Baseline	Target (90 days post-launch)
30-Day Retention Rate	38%	55%
Weekly Sessions / Active User	1.8	2.5
Squad Participation Rate	0%	30% of MAU
Instructor Profile Views / Session	0.12	0.55
NPS Score	24	38
Push Notification CTR (Challenge)	—	18%+

4. Feature 1 — Squad Challenges

4.1 Feature Overview

Squad Challenges introduces a persistent social layer to VitaFit. Users form or join small groups (squads of 3–8 people), commit to shared fitness challenges over defined time windows (weekly, biweekly, monthly), and earn XP and badges based on group participation and individual contribution. A real-time leaderboard creates friendly competition and habit-reinforcing accountability.

DESIGN NORTH STAR	Every feature decision should make users feel that their squad is counting on them — turning individual fitness into a shared commitment.

4.2 User Stories

- As a user, I want to create a squad and invite friends so that we can hold each other accountable.
- As a user, I want to join a public squad challenge so that I can meet new people with similar fitness goals.
- As a user, I want to earn XP when I complete sessions during an active challenge so that I feel rewarded for consistency.
- As a user, I want to see my squad's leaderboard so that I know how I rank and feel motivated to stay active.
- As a user, I want to receive a push notification when my squad is falling behind so that I feel a sense of urgency.
- As a user, I want to earn achievement badges for challenge milestones so that I can display progress on my profile.

4.3 Functional Requirements

Squad Formation

- Users can create a private squad (invite-only via link or username) or join a public squad from a discovery feed
- Squad size: minimum 3, maximum 8 members
- Squad admin can set the challenge type (class count, duration minutes, or calorie goal), time window, and difficulty tier
- Users can belong to a maximum of 2 active squads simultaneously

Challenge Engine

- Three challenge templates at launch: Weekly Warriors (7-day class count), Endurance Month (30-day total minutes), Burn Blitz (biweekly calorie goal)
- XP is awarded per completed session: base XP scales by class duration; bonus XP for streak days and squad-boosted sessions

- Squad progress is aggregated in real time and displayed as a shared progress bar
- Individual contribution is shown alongside squad total to prevent free-riding

Leaderboard & Gamification

- Two leaderboard views: 'My Squad' (relative ranking among squad members) and 'Global' (top 100 squads in same challenge tier)
- Achievement badges: Streak Keeper (5-day streak), Squad MVP (top contributor in challenge), Challenge Champion (squad completes 100% of goal)
- Badges are displayed on user profiles and visible to instructors
- End-of-challenge summary card is shareable to external social platforms

Notifications & Re-engagement

- Opt-in push notifications: challenge start reminder, squad activity digest (daily), halfway milestone alert, final 24-hour warning
- Dormancy detection: if a user has not logged a session for 3 days during an active challenge, send a personalized nudge: 'Your squad completed 4 sessions yesterday — you're 2 behind!'

4.4 Non-Functional Requirements

- Leaderboard must refresh within 60 seconds of a session being logged
- Squad discovery feed must load within 1.5 seconds on a 4G connection
- XP calculation must be idempotent — duplicate session submissions must not double-award XP
- Notifications must support user-level frequency capping (max 2 per day per user)

4.5 Out of Scope (v1)

- Cash prizes or real-money rewards
- Squad video chat or live group sessions
- Squad challenges with instructor-led live events (Phase 2 consideration)

5. Feature 2 — Instructor Connection Hub

5.1 Feature Overview

The Instructor Connection Hub transforms instructors from anonymous content producers into personal coaches users feel connected to. It introduces rich instructor profiles, an async Q&A system, and a milestone-aware interaction layer that surfaces personalized instructor messages at key moments in a user's journey — completing their first class, hitting a 10-session streak, or finishing a challenge.

DESIGN NORTH STAR	Users should feel that their favorite instructor knows them — even at scale. Personalization should feel human, not algorithmic.

5.2 User Stories

- As a user, I want to view an instructor's full profile (bio, teaching style, class history) so that I can decide which instructors match my goals.
- As a user, I want to 'follow' an instructor so that I get notified when they publish new content or go live.
- As a user, I want to submit a question to an instructor after a class so that I can get personalized guidance.
- As a user, I want to receive a message from my instructor when I hit a milestone so that I feel recognized and motivated.
- As an instructor, I want to see which students follow me and their recent activity so that I can personalize my responses.
- As an instructor, I want to send broadcast messages to my followers so that I can announce new classes or challenges.

5.3 Functional Requirements

Instructor Profiles

- Each instructor has a dedicated profile page: photo, bio, specializations (yoga, HIIT, zumba, etc.), teaching philosophy, class catalog, and student testimonials
- Profile displays aggregated stats: total classes taught, average rating, follower count, badge earned from students
- 'Follow' button persists across sessions; followers receive instructor activity notifications
- Instructors can add a short weekly video message ('Weekly Motivation') visible only to their followers

Async Q&A

- After each completed class, users see a prompt: 'Got a question for [Instructor]?' with a text input (max 280 characters)
- Instructors see a moderated Q&A inbox, prioritized by follower count and recency
- Instructor responses are public (visible to all followers of that instructor) or private (only to the asker)
- Top-voted Q&A pairs surface in the instructor's profile under 'Community Insights'
- Response time SLA target: instructors are nudged to respond within 48 hours; users are notified when answered

Milestone Moments

- Trigger events: first completed class, 5-class milestone, 10-class streak, challenge completion, 30-day anniversary
- For each trigger, the system surfaces a pre-personalized message from the class instructor: 'Great work finishing your first yoga flow, [Name]! Here is what to focus on next…'

- Messages are authored by instructors in batches using a template system; variables include user name, class name, and milestone type
- Users can react to milestone messages (heart, fire, clap) and reply — creating a one-to-one async dialogue

Instructor Dashboard

- Instructors access a lightweight dashboard showing: new Q&A messages, recent follower milestones, class completion rates, and top-performing classes by follower engagement
- Dashboard available on web and mobile; push notifications for new Q&A submissions

5.4 Non-Functional Requirements

- Q&A inbox must handle 10,000+ concurrent instructor users without degradation
- Milestone message delivery must occur within 5 minutes of the triggering event
- All Q&A content must pass automated moderation before being visible (PII scrubbing, toxicity detection)
- Instructor profiles must be cacheable with a 5-minute TTL to handle traffic spikes after a class ends

5.5 Out of Scope (v1)

- Live 1:1 video sessions between instructors and users
- Monetized instructor tipping or premium DM access
- AI-generated instructor persona responses (Phase 3 consideration)

6. User Experience & Design Principles

Principle	Squad Challenges Application	Instructor Hub Application
Accountability over Surveillance	Show squad progress; never expose individual absence to public	Milestone messages feel celebratory, not corrective
Effort Visibility	XP and badges reflect consistency, not just raw performance	Q&A responses are visible to all followers — effort scales
Emotional Warmth	End-of-challenge cards use warm copy and celebration animations	Instructor photos, videos, and personal bios humanize the platform
Progressive Disclosure	New users start with simple 7-day challenge; complexity unlocks over time	Follow prompt appears naturally post-class, not as a popup

7. Technical Considerations

7.1 Architecture Notes

- Squad state management: event-sourced architecture recommended; each session completion emits an immutable event consumed by the XP engine, leaderboard service, and notification service independently
- Instructor Q&A: async message queue (e.g., SQS or Pub/Sub) to decouple submission from moderation and delivery
- Milestone triggers: rule engine listening to user event stream; must be idempotent to prevent duplicate milestone messages

7.2 Data & Privacy

- Squad membership and XP data are user-owned; exportable on request (GDPR/CCPA compliance)
- Instructor Q&A submissions are subject to content moderation before storage
- User display names in leaderboards are pseudonymized by default; users can opt in to full name display

7.3 Integrations

- Push notification: existing FCM/APNS integration extended with new event types
- Content metadata: class duration, category, and instructor ID pulled from existing CMS for XP calculation
- Analytics: all new user interactions tracked to existing event pipeline with new event schema versions

8. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Instructor Q&A inbox overwhelm	High	Prioritization algorithm + 48hr SLA nudge + batch reply tools
Toxic content in squad/Q&A	Medium	Automated moderation + reporting flow + 24hr human review SLA
Low instructor participation in milestone messaging	Medium	Onboarding incentive program; highlight top-engaged instructors
Leaderboard discouraging low-performing users	Medium	Default view shows squad-relative rank (not global); opt-in global
Squad feature adoption below 20% in first 30 days	Low-Medium	Onboarding flow prompts squad join; 'starter squads' auto-created

9. Phased Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Scope
Phase 1 — MVP	Weeks 1–8	Squad creation, 3 challenge templates, XP + basic badges, Instructor profiles, Follow functionality, Post-class Q&A submission
Phase 2 — Growth	Weeks 9–16	Global leaderboard, Milestone messages, Instructor dashboard, Shareable challenge summary cards, Dormancy re-engagement notifications
Phase 3 — Scale	Weeks 17–24	Instructor-led squad challenges (live events), AI-assisted Q&A drafting for instructors, Badge marketplace, Cross-platform social sharing

10. Stakeholders & Sign-Off

Role	Stakeholder	Responsibility
Product Owner	VP Product, VitaFit	Final feature approval and prioritization
Engineering Lead	Backend + Frontend Leads	Technical feasibility, sprint planning
Design Lead	Head of UX/UI	User flows, visual system, prototype review
Instructor Relations	Content Partnerships Manager	Instructor onboarding, Q&A tooling adoption
Data / Analytics	Growth Analytics Lead	Metric baseline, event schema, dashboard setup
Legal / Privacy	Counsel	GDPR/CCPA review, content moderation policy

Appendix A — Glossary

XP (Experience Points): Numerical score awarded per completed session; accumulates within a challenge window and resets at the start of each new challenge.

Squad: A group of 3–8 VitaFit users joined for a shared fitness challenge.

Milestone Moment: A system-triggered event (e.g., 10th class completed) that surfaces a personalized instructor message to the user.

Dormancy Nudge: A re-engagement push notification sent to a user who has been inactive for 3+ days during an active squad challenge.

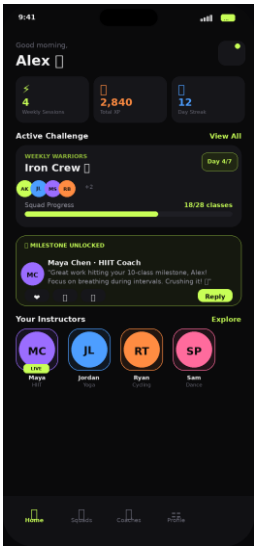
XP Engine: The backend service responsible for calculating, awarding, and persisting XP in real time based on user session completion events.

Appendix B — UI/UX Prototype Screens

The following screens represent the complete interactive iPhone 15 prototype built from this PRD. Each screen addresses user pain points from §2.2 and implements requirements from §4 (Squad Challenges) and §5 (Instructor Connection Hub).

Design principles: All key actions within 2 taps · Consistent gamification cues (XP, badges, progress) · Real-time social data for accountability · Contextual instructor touchpoints at peak emotional moments.

B.1 Screen 1 — Home Dashboard



B.1

⚠ User Problem

Users lose motivation without visible accountability and social pressure (PRD §2.2).

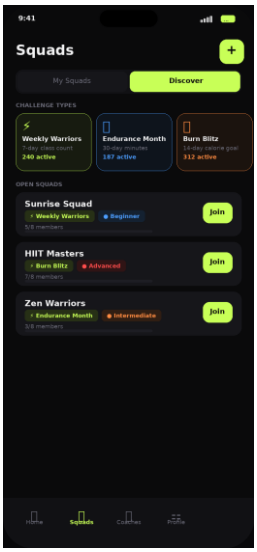
✓ How This Solves It

Makes social accountability visible on every app open. Every element is designed to trigger a return visit.

→ Key UX Decisions

- Stat pills (Sessions, XP, Streak) turn abstract engagement into numbers users want to grow.
- Active Challenge card shows squad progress (18/28, 64%) with individual contribution — prevents free-riding.
- Milestone Moment card surfaces instructor message from §5.1 trigger above the fold.
- Instructor strip with LIVE badge: one tap to the Connection Hub.
- Bell badge creates re-engagement pull without a push notification.

B.2 Screen 2 — Squad Discovery



B.2

⚠ User Problem

Users feel no social accountability; VitaFit is interchangeable with any fitness library (PRD §2.2).

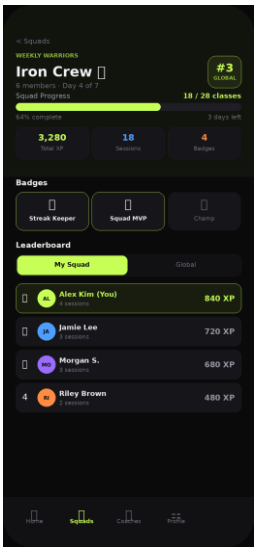
✓ How This Solves It

Implements PRD §4 community layer. Fulfils: "I want to join a public squad to meet people with similar goals."

→ Key UX Decisions

- Challenge Type cards with live counts (312 active squads) create social proof and urgency.
- Open Squads: fill level (5/8), difficulty badge, one-tap Join — under 2 seconds friction.
- Pill tabs surface active squad count, respecting the PRD max 2 active squads rule.
- + button triggers squad creation: "I want to create a squad and invite friends."

B.3 Screen 3 — Squad Detail & Leaderboard



B.3

⚠ User Problem

Without visible rankings, users have no competitive pressure to return and log sessions (PRD §2.2).

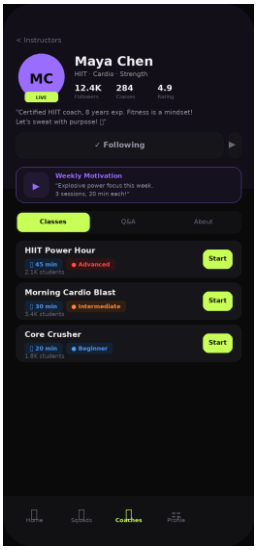
✓ How This Solves It

The accountability engine — fulfils PRD §4.3 full gamification loop. The screen users return to most.

→ Key UX Decisions

- Hero shows squad name, Day 4/7, and Global Rank (#3) all above the fold.
- Progress bar (64%, 3 days left) creates urgency that drives session completion.
- Locked Challenge Champion badge is a deliberate behavioral nudge per PRD §4.3.
- My Squad leaderboard with gold/silver/bronze makes individual effort transparent.
- Global tab fulfils PRD two-leaderboard-view requirement.

B.4 Screen 4 — Instructor Profile



B.4

⚠ User Problem

Users feel no personal connection to instructors — VitaFit feels interchangeable (PRD §1).

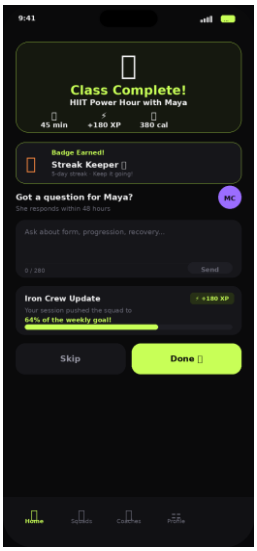
✓ How This Solves It

Primary Instructor Connection Hub interface (PRD §5). Transforms instructors from anonymous producers into coaches.

→ Key UX Decisions

- LIVE badge, 12.4K followers, 284 classes, 4.9 rating — establishes credibility per PRD §5.3.
- Weekly Motivation (exclusive follower content) is a strong follow incentive.
- Q&A tab: Community Insights per PRD §5.3, top-voted questions surfaced.
- Ask a question (280 chars, 48h SLA): instructor contact friction reduced to zero.

B.5 Screen 5 — Post-Class & Q&A Prompt



B.5

⚠ User Problem

Users get no recognition after workouts and have no natural moment to connect with instructors (PRD §5.1).

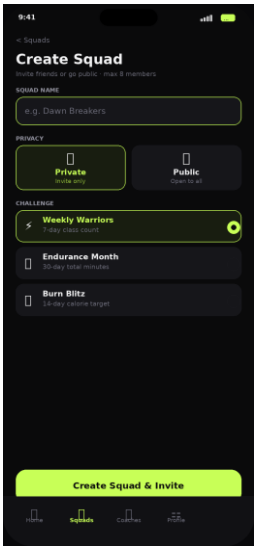
✓ How This Solves It

Captures the peak motivation moment immediately after class to reinforce achievement and open instructor dialogue.

→ Key UX Decisions

- Completion banner (45 min, +180 XP, 380 cal) anchors the habit loop at peak motivation.
- Badge Earned card surfaces achievement at emotional peak per PRD §4.3.
- Q&A prompt with instructor avatar after class — most natural moment, zero navigation.
- Squad Update closes the loop: shows session contributed 64% squad progress.
- Skip vs. Done: respects autonomy; Done (accent color) is visually dominant.

B.6 Screen 6 — Create Squad



B.6

⚠ User Problem

Squad formation must be frictionless for users to invest in the social system (PRD §4.3).

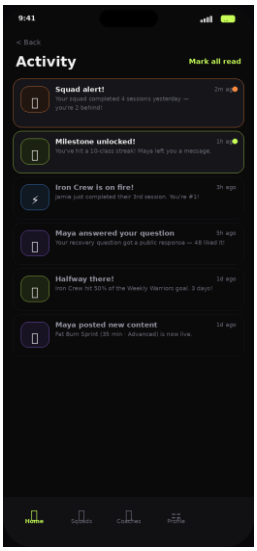
✓ How This Solves It

Linear form with visual selection — implements all PRD §4.3 Squad Formation requirements with minimal cognitive load.

→ Key UX Decisions

- Name input with accent border on focus provides immediate visual feedback.
- Privacy cards (Private lock / Public globe): binary, tap-friendly — no dropdowns.
- Three Challenge Type cards match PRD-mandated templates exactly.
- Difficulty picker (blue/orange/red) uses consistent app-wide color language.
- Max 8 members surfaced in subtitle — manages expectations per PRD §4.3.

B.7 Screen 7 — Activity & Notifications



B.7

⚠ User Problem

Users need timely re-engagement signals to prevent dormancy during challenges (PRD §4.3).

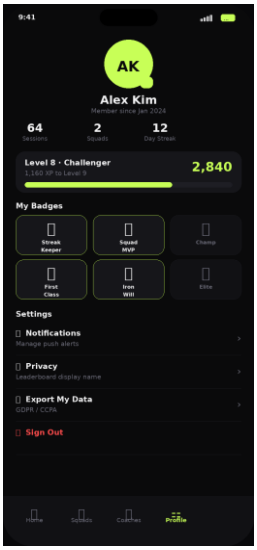
✓ How This Solves It

Implements full PRD §4.3 re-engagement system: dormancy nudges, milestone alerts, squad updates in one feed.

→ Key UX Decisions

- Unread items (top 2) have card backgrounds and colored borders — most urgent first.
- Squad Alert is the exact PRD §4.3 dormancy nudge: "Your squad completed 4 sessions — you're 2 behind!"
- Milestone Unlocked links to instructor message — notification to engagement in one tap.
- Activity icons (bell, trophy, lightning, speech bubble) allow glance-level categorization.

B.8 Screen 8 — User Profile & Badges



B.8

⚠ User Problem

Without a visible achievement record, users lack long-term motivation to return (PRD §3.1).

✓ How This Solves It

Creates permanent fitness identity — turning progress history into assets users do not want to abandon.

→ Key UX Decisions

- XP Level bar (Level 8, 2,840 XP, 1,160 to next): the single most powerful retention mechanic.
- Badge grid (earned vs. locked): all PRD §4.3 types; locked badges motivate completion.
- Stats (64 sessions, 2 squads, 12-day streak) anchor fitness identity — assets worth protecting.
- Privacy + Export My Data per PRD §7.2 GDPR/CCPA compliance.
- Squad badges visible here bridge both features into a unified identity.

B.9 Prototype — Retention Loop Summary

The eight screens form a complete behavioral loop targeting VitaFit's 38% → 55%+ retention goal. (1) Home: social accountability on every open. (2) Squad mechanics: peer obligation that pulls users back. (3) Leaderboard + XP: reward consistency. (4) Instructor profile + Q&A: make VitaFit irreplaceable. (5) Notifications: personalized nudges at exactly the right moments.

These features target the 2.3x higher 90-day retention benchmark (PRD §2.3). Every feature reinforces every other: completing a class triggers a milestone message (instructor connection) AND updates squad progress (social accountability) simultaneously — compounding the retention effect of each interaction.